

Letter

Letter: Inflation debate – what goes around comes around

From William McClain, Rockville, MD, US



Loretta Mester, president and chief executive officer of Federal Reserve Bank of Cleveland © Melissa Lyttle/Bloomberg

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Saturday's Big Read ("The escalating fight against inflation", [FT Weekend](#), September 24) quotes Christian Keller of Barclays Investment Bank as saying the Federal Reserve has become "afraid of losing control of the [inflation] process".

I recall attending a symposium with Janet Yellen, Ben Bernanke, Olivier Blanchard, Loretta Mester and others at a Washington think-tank in 2019 where the topic was "missing" inflation after the Great Recession.

Then the issue was a decade of below-target inflation despite highly accommodative policy. Now we may face stubbornly high inflation despite aggressive rate raising. Perhaps then as now, our central banks don't have as much control over the "inflation process" as we'd like to imagine?

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